When the Chat Ends, the Work Continues

A method for carrying project judgment
into the next AI conversation.
Demonstrated through 13 response audits.

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01 **Prepare**
Carry the project history.

02 **Challenge**
Test the handoff itself.

03 **Audit**
Review 13 new responses.

04 **Direct**
Return one clear instruction.

05 **Verify**
Check what changed.

THE CASE STUDY

Credit Decisioning Strategy (CDS)

A synthetic application portfolio and credit decision simulator.

github.com/andrew-goad/credit_decisioning_strategy

THE THREE-CHAT REVIEW METHOD

Three chats, with me directing the handoff

1 **Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build**
Built the synthetic portfolio and retained its implementation history.

2 **Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation**
Developed the business requirements document (BRD) and validation evidence.

3 **Module 2 Decision Simulator Build**
Received the handoff and built the credit decision simulator.

One missing, restored requirement shows why I kept reviewing.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

CHATGPT

The response added several Section 13 patches, but I do not see that specific diagnostic clearly represented.

HOW THE REVIEW WORKED

I filtered 13 early Module 2 responses through both Module 1 chats to preserve the intended direction after handoff.

BEFORE DELIVERY · MAY 5

Use both Module 1 chats to refine the handoff and agree on it before delivery

01 **Draft** → 02 **Challenge** → 03 **Consolidate** → 04 **Check** → 05 **Confirm**

ANDREW
Let's discuss how to begin module 2 new chat. Please help me craft an excellent prompt.

ChatGPT / Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build
Module 2 is a new downstream module. The scope is strategy outcomes, not production decisions. The output should preserve auditability and scenario comparability. The first task is architecture, not code.

ANDREW
How is this updated prompt? Please recommend any changes to context or order.

ChatGPT / Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation
The prompt will be more effective if it first establishes Module 1 authority, then Module 2 objective and boundaries, relationship/naming discipline, expected scope, validation/design expectations, and the exact first response format.

ChatGPT / Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation
Module 2 should enforce clear consistency between decision outcomes, decision paths, flags, approved amount, and approved Expected Loss.

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

After 7 prompt-and-response rounds across both chats, including final consistency checks, I delivered the confirmed handoff to Module 2.

LAUNCH · MAY 6

The new chat proposed a plan before writing code

I supplied the finished code and documentation, preserved Module 1’s boundaries, and asked for architecture before implementation.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Read the attached Module 1 SQL, BRD, and Validation Summary before proposing Module 2 architecture. Treat its finalized outputs, terminology, and boundaries as authoritative. Do not redesign Module 1 unless explicitly instructed.

ANDREW

Do not start coding immediately. Start by designing Module 2 architecture.

CHATGPT

Establish the strategy settings, source-data layer and fail-fast checks before writing decision logic. Only then build the decision rules, explanations, approved-amount calculations and final output.

WHY IT MATTERS

The response gave me a sequence to audit: settings and checks first, then decision logic. I sent the plan to both experienced chats.

INITIAL ARCHITECTURE REVIEW

Both experienced chats reviewed the first response

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the new chat’s first response. Do you agree with its direction? What should I refine?

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

For the initial build, keep MANUAL_REVIEW unresolved. Do not treat it as approved exposure.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Module 2 should not recalculate the synthetic estimated-PD proxy in the initial v1.0 build.

WHY IT MATTERS

The reviews kept manual review unresolved and preserved Module 1’s risk estimate. I locked those conventions before authorizing SQL.

INITIAL ARCHITECTURE REVIEW · CLOSING THE LOOP

I returned the decisions before authorizing code

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Lock the following design decisions, then briefly restate the final Module 2 architecture. Do not write full code yet.

CHATGPT

Module 1 outputs remain authoritative. estimated_pd is only a synthetic estimated-PD proxy. Module 2 will not recalculate it, create a post-decision risk model in v1.0, or reinterpret Module 1 scenarios as forecasts.

THE REPEATED DISCIPLINE

That became the repeated discipline: review a response, return a complete instruction, then inspect what happened next.

AUDIT 01 / 13 · FOUNDATION AND ASSUMPTIONS

The first build stayed small enough to review

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the first Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

Build only the initial setup, strategy parameters and validation checks.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Strategy settings, source validation and fail-fast checks—not decision logic.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Let’s proceed to the first SQL build, but please follow the constraints below exactly. Do not build decision logic yet.

CHATGPT

This first build creates the strategy settings and fail-fast validation. It does not yet build decision rules, reason codes, approved amounts or final output.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor delivered setup and checks first. I could inspect the foundation before decision rules depended on it.

AUDIT 02 / 13 · FOUNDATION AND ASSUMPTIONS

Check the foundation before adding dependent code

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the second Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

If you find any issue in the setup, strategy parameters or checks, provide a targeted BEFORE / AFTER patch first.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

compare business fields and decision fields, excluding purely time-based audit fields unless the test is specifically validating run metadata.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Before adding the source-data layer, review the setup, strategy parameters and checks already delivered.

CHATGPT

The patch tightens handling of missing values and keeps strategy_run_id / strategy_run_ts within the audit-metadata boundary.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor reported fixes before adding the source layer. Review happened before an error could spread into new code.

AUDIT 03 / 13 · FOUNDATION AND ASSUMPTIONS

“Borderline” became an explicit policy setting

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the third Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

borderline_profile_flag should identify applicants close to strategy thresholds; it should not assign manual review yet.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Do not create hidden “borderline” magic numbers. If borderline_profile_flag needs a buffer, use an existing parameter or propose an explicit parameter-and-validation patch.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Do not introduce a hidden hardcoded borderline buffer.

CHATGPT

borderline_profile_flag requires an explicit, adjustable buffer. This patch adds one rather than hardcoding a hidden 5% or 10% cutoff.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor added the buffer parameter. Reviewers could now see and adjust the near-threshold policy choice.

AUDIT 04 / 13 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS

Risk was measured against the right loan amount

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the fourth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

Use product_approve_max_requested_el for the low/moderate requested Expected Loss split. It is a requested-exposure threshold; product_approved_el_cap applies later, after exposure treatment.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

product_approved_el_cap may still be carried forward for transparency and later approved-exposure logic, but it should not drive pre-decision requested Expected Loss tiering.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The correction separated the original request from a later offer. Risk tiers would use the requested-amount thresholds.

AUDIT 04 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS · THE CORRECTION

Classify the request before calculating the offer

An applicant’s requested amount and a later approved amount can differ. Using the later offer’s risk limit to classify the original request mixes two stages.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

product_approve_max_requested_el governs requested-exposure Expected Loss classification. product_approved_el_cap applies after exposure treatment. At this pre-decision stage, approved_expected_loss_amount does not exist yet. Use requested-exposure thresholds only.

CHATGPT

The requested-risk classification patch is appropriate. Keep product_approved_el_cap for later approved-exposure logic. Pre-decision requested Expected Loss tiering must use requested-exposure thresholds only.

WHAT CHANGED

The successor accepted the distinction and supplied a targeted patch. Earlier risk tiers would use requested-amount thresholds.

AUDIT 05 / 13 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS

A possible smaller offer stayed provisional

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the fifth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

A smaller offer still needs approved-amount, payment, payment-to-income and Expected Loss calculations. Those calculations do not exist yet.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Manual review is the safest preliminary route for severe requested-structure stress that remains unresolved at this stage.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

These are preliminary routing outcomes only. They should not be interpreted as final strategy outcomes.

CHATGPT

The preliminary routing flags now identify applicants who need a smaller-offer feasibility test or an approved-amount calculation.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor kept routing provisional. A smaller offer still had to pass its affordability and risk checks.

AUDIT 06 / 13 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS

The builder checked that earlier controls were in place

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the sixth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

The next layer should calculate preliminary approved-exposure economics and test whether a smaller offer is feasible.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Treat the preliminary routing layer as provisionally accepted, subject to checking the code already delivered.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Before adding approved-amount and smaller-offer calculations, review the rule checks and preliminary routing code already delivered.

CHATGPT

The routing layer contains the required preliminary fields. It does not yet create final decisions, reason codes, approved amounts, payments, payment-to-income ratios or Expected Loss.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The builder reported its pre-flight code review. I checked that earlier controls existed before allowing the next layer.

AUDIT 07 / 13 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS

Failed offers got an explicit handling policy

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the seventh Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

default failed counteroffer handling should route to MANUAL_REVIEW, not automatic DECLINE, unless the strategy explicitly chooses otherwise.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Explicitly confirm failed counteroffers are resolved by governed parameter, not hidden logic.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

failed_counteroffer_resolution. Recommended default: MANUAL_REVIEW. Allowed values: MANUAL_REVIEW, DECLINE.

CHATGPT

Allowed values: MANUAL_REVIEW, DECLINE.
Default: MANUAL_REVIEW.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor added a policy setting: manual review by default, or an explicit choice to decline. The assumption was visible.

AUDIT 08 / 13 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS

Exact label matching became a required check

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the eighth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

The reason-code layer should explain the outcomes already finalized by the decision layer; it should not alter them.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

some proposed reason labels appear close but not necessarily identical to the failure-reason strings we previously established.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Use the exact reason-code labels already established. Do not invent close-but-different strings.

CHATGPT

No label mismatch found; no patch required.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The builder reported no mismatch. The next audit still found a label inconsistency and a reason-rule error. A self-check needed review.

AUDIT 09 / 13 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS

A smaller offer needed the correct explanation

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the ninth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

The raw feasible amount is the smallest of the limits. The product cap is binding when it equals that amount, not when it is less.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Reason-code assignment should be deterministic and label-aligned. A one-character mismatch can silently prevent the intended candidate reason from firing.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor corrected the comparison. A product limit that actually constrained the offer could now be named as its reason.

AUDIT 09 · DECISION LOGIC AND EXPLANATIONS · THE CODE CHANGE

The smallest limit must explain the smaller offer

ILLUSTRATION · BEFORE ROUNDING

Other constraints allow $12,000; the product limit is $10,000. The feasible offer is $10,000, so the product limit explains the reduction.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

The product cap is binding when: counteroffer_product_cap_amount = counteroffer_raw_max_feasible_amount

BEFORE · $10,000 < $10,000 IS FALSE: THE REASON IS MISSED

CHATGPT

AND counteroffer_product_cap_amount < counteroffer_raw_max_feasible_amount

AFTER · $10,000 = $10,000 IS TRUE: THE REASON IS RECOGNIZED

CHATGPT

AND counteroffer_product_cap_amount = counteroffer_raw_max_feasible_amount

WHY IT MATTERS

“Equals” identifies the limit that set the offer. “Less than” can miss that reason.

AUDIT 10 / 13 · VALIDATION AND PRESERVATION

The count check had to require exactly one decision

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the tenth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

Tighten the “exactly one final flag” gatekeeper from “greater than 1” to “not equal to 1.”

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Require schema compatibility / archive column alignment before insert.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Please revise the count test so it fails whenever the sum of final decision flags is not exactly 1.

CHATGPT

```
OR ( COALESCE(approval_flag::INT, 0) +
COALESCE(counteroffer_flag::INT, 0) +
COALESCE(manual_review_flag::INT, 0) +
COALESCE(decline_flag::INT, 0) ) <> 1
```

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The direct count check now rejects both zero and multiple flags. Other outcome checks already existed; this made the requirement explicit.

AUDIT 11 / 13 · VALIDATION AND PRESERVATION

The archive had to preserve the original result

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the eleventh Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

Add a schema data-type alignment check, not just a missing-column check.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Use IS DISTINCT FROM for comparisons so NULL handling remains explicit and safe.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Purpose: If the archive table already existed from an earlier build, it may contain the same column names but incompatible data types.

CHATGPT

The archive check confirms the saved result preserves the original decisions, amounts, affordability measures, Expected Loss, reason codes and source lineage.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The successor added archive checks. Saved amounts and explanations had to match the original result, with compatible types.

AUDIT 12 / 13 · VALIDATION AND PRESERVATION

My returned instruction omitted the same-data check

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the twelfth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

Before comparing the baseline and alternative strategies, verify that each matched application has identical original Module 1 data.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Add an explicit check that blocks comparing a strategy run with itself.

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Add an explicit check that blocks comparing a strategy run with itself.

CHATGPT

Comparing a strategy with itself is not a valid strategy comparison.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

The builder blocked comparisons of a strategy with itself. My returned instruction omitted the check that both runs used identical source data. The next audit caught it.

AUDIT 13 / 13 · VALIDATION AND PRESERVATION

The next review caught the missing source-data check

ANDREW · REVIEW REQUEST TO BOTH CHATS

Evaluate the thirteenth Module 2 follow-up response.

ChatGPT Module 1 BRD / Validation Documentation

The earlier request was to check that both strategies use the same original application data. The response added several Section 13 patches, but I do not see that specific diagnostic clearly represented.

ChatGPT Module 1 Synthetic Application Portfolio Build

Before capture, add the missing source-data consistency check and a compact validation status summary.

WHAT CHANGED · WHY IT MATTERS

This is the omission from page 2. I restored the check before assembly; later campaign diagnostics reported zero source-field mismatches.

AUDIT 13 · VALIDATION AND PRESERVATION · THE RESTORED CHECK

Compare policy changes on the same source data

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Add a check that the baseline and alternative strategies use identical original Module 1 data for every matched application.

CHATGPT

The final capture plan includes both additions: the check that matched applications have identical Module 1 source data, and the compact validation status summary.

WHAT CHANGED

I returned the missing requirement explicitly and required it in the full-script capture. Every strategy comparison had to use the same original application data.

AFTER AUDIT 13

I captured the complete code in controlled parts

ChatGPT Module 2 Decision Simulator Build

ANDREW

Because the full script is long, do not try to force the entire file into one response if it risks truncation.

ANDREW

Do not skip ahead. Do not include non-SQL prose inside the SQL code block except SQL comments. Do not include Parts 2–7 until I ask for them.

CHATGPT

Ready for next part: say CONTINUE FULL CODE PART 2

WHY IT MATTERS

Seven defined parts, with start/end markers and all accepted patches integrated.

THE TRANSFERABLE PRACTICE

A method to use before the chat reaches its limit

01 **Prepare while the history is available**

Ground the handoff in current files, accepted decisions and the next bounded task.

02 **Review the handoff itself**

Have a chat with project history challenge the handoff and reconcile the revisions.

03 **Test the successor before extending the work**

Ask for a restatement or architecture. Review the first responses and verify corrections.

04 **Keep completion outside the chat**

Save complete artifacts, track open requirements and validate the integrated result.

IF THE CHAT IS ALREADY FULL

Branch from an earlier point. Supply the later decisions, corrections and current files. Use the updated branch to refine the handoff and audit the successor’s first responses.

THE RESULT · EVIDENCE READERS CAN INSPECT

Built-in controls and campaign scale

76,723

physical SQL lines

Retained Module 2 release

39

archived strategy runs

50,000 decision rows per run

1.95M

archived decision rows

Repeated evaluations of synthetic applications

Zero source-field mismatches

20 matched comparisons

Original application data preserved.

All passed

10 final readiness gates

Zero critical convention violations.

BUILT INTO THE SIMULATOR

Explicit policy settings. Correct thresholds and reasons.
One final decision per application. Archive and source-data checks.

The chat can end.

Keep the project’s judgment in the loop.

Carry forward the decisions that matter.

Challenge the successor’s understanding.

Verify that accepted corrections survive.

Andrew R. Goad

Human-in-the-Loop AI Continuity

For leaders who need AI work to remain reviewable through every transition.

EXPLORE THE PROJECT AND PUBLISHED EVIDENCE

github.com/andrew-goad/credit_decisioning_strategy